COMPANY HR POLICY — UNITED KINGDOM
Version 2024 | Applicable to all UK-based employees

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1. WORKING HOURS
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Standard working hours are 37.5 hours per week (7.5 hours/day, Monday to Friday).
The Working Time Regulations 1998 cap working hours at 48 hours per week (averaged over 17 weeks).
Employees may opt out of the 48-hour limit by signing an opt-out agreement.
Overtime is paid at 1.25x the normal rate for hours beyond 37.5 per week.
Rest breaks: 20-minute break for shifts exceeding 6 hours (statutory minimum).
Daily rest: Minimum 11 consecutive hours between working days.

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2. LEAVE POLICY
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Annual Leave:
- Statutory minimum: 28 days (including 8 public holidays) per year.
- Company enhanced entitlement: 33 days (including 8 public holidays).
- Leave year runs from 1st January to 31st December.
- Maximum carry-forward: 5 days to the following leave year.
- Unused leave above carry-forward limit is forfeited.

Sick Leave:
- Statutory Sick Pay (SSP): £116.75 per week (2024 rate) from Day 4 of illness.
- Company enhanced sick pay: Full pay for up to 10 days per rolling 12-month period.
- Self-certification for first 7 days; GP certificate required beyond 7 days.

Maternity Leave:
- Statutory Maternity Leave: Up to 52 weeks (26 weeks Ordinary + 26 weeks Additional).
- Statutory Maternity Pay (SMP): 90% of average weekly earnings for first 6 weeks,
  then £184.03/week (or 90% if lower) for next 33 weeks.
- Company enhanced maternity pay: Full pay for 16 weeks, then SMP rates.
- KIT (Keeping In Touch) days: Up to 10 days can be worked without ending maternity leave.

Paternity Leave:
- 2 weeks statutory paid paternity leave within 56 days of birth/adoption.
- SPP (Statutory Paternity Pay): £184.03/week or 90% of earnings, whichever is lower.
- Company enhanced: Full pay for 2 weeks paternity leave.

Shared Parental Leave:
- Parents can share up to 50 weeks leave and 37 weeks pay between them.
- Must give 8 weeks notice to the company before taking shared parental leave.

Adoption Leave:

- Eligible employees can take up to 52 weeks adoption leave.
- Statutory Adoption Pay mirrors SMP rates.

Public Holidays (Bank Holidays):
- 8 bank holidays in England and Wales: New Year's Day, Good Friday, Easter Monday,
  Early May Bank Holiday, Spring Bank Holiday, Summer Bank Holiday, Christmas Day,
  Boxing Day.
- Scotland and Northern Ireland have different bank holiday schedules.

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3. PROBATION PERIOD
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Standard probation period is 6 months.
Review meetings at 1 month, 3 months, and end of probation.
Notice period during probation: 1 week (statutory minimum).
Probation may be extended by up to 3 months with written notification.
Employees on probation have all statutory rights from Day 1 (holiday, SSP, etc.).

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4. NOTICE PERIOD
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Statutory minimum notice after probation: 1 week per year of service (up to 12 weeks).
Company contractual notice: 1 month for employees; 1 month for company.
Senior roles (Manager and above): 3 months notice on both sides.
Payment in lieu of notice (PILON) may be offered at company discretion.
Garden leave: Company may place employees on garden leave during notice period.

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5. REDUNDANCY
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Statutory Redundancy Pay: 0.5 week pay per year under age 22,
                          1 week pay per year aged 22-40,
                          1.5 weeks pay per year aged 41+.
Maximum weekly pay for redundancy calculation: £643 (2024 rate).
Enhanced redundancy: Company pays 1.5x statutory redundancy pay.
Consultation period: 30 days for 20-99 redundancies; 45 days for 100+ redundancies.
Employees under 2 years service have no right to statutory redundancy pay.

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6. PENSION
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Auto-enrolment pension scheme in compliance with the Pensions Act 2008.
Minimum employer contribution: 3% of qualifying earnings.
Company enhanced contribution: 5% employer + 4% employee = 9% total.
Employees can opt out but are re-enrolled every 3 years.

Pension provider: Company uses a workplace pension through a regulated provider.

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7. PERFORMANCE REVIEW
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Annual appraisals conducted in March.
Quarterly one-to-ones with line manager throughout the year.
Rating scale: Outstanding, Exceeds Expectations, Meets Expectations,
Developing, Unsatisfactory.
Pay reviews effective April 1, aligned with the new leave year.
Capability procedure initiated for Unsatisfactory rating with full support and PIP process.

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8. DISCIPLINARY & GRIEVANCE
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The company follows the ACAS Code of Practice on disciplinary and grievance procedures.
Disciplinary stages: Verbal warning → Written warning → Final written warning → Dismissal.
Employees have the right to be accompanied at disciplinary hearings by a colleague or trade union rep.
Grievance procedure: Informal resolution → Formal grievance → Appeal.
All disciplinary and grievance records retained for 5 years post-resolution.